Idaho Technology Authority (ITA)

ENTERPRISE POLICY – P2000 INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY PLANNING POLICIES

Category: P2030 – INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY LARGE-SCALE PROJECT REVIEW

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I. AUTHORITY

Authority: Idaho Code § 67-831 through § 67-833

II. ABSTRACT

All agency IT projects are subject to review by the Office of Information Technology Services (ITS) in accordance with applicable statutes, budget processes, and statewide policies.

In support of the Idaho Technology Authority's statutory responsibility under Idaho Code § 67-833 to review Large-Scale information technology projects, this policy establishes that certain projects with significant statewide financial, operational, security, or public service impact require additional review and approval by the ITA prior to proceeding.

Enterprise impact thresholds and screening criteria used to identify such projects will be defined and maintained within ITS policies and standards to ensure consistent, objective, and statewide application. Projects meeting these established thresholds will be referred to the ITA for formal review.

For these selected information technology and telecommunications projects, State agencies will be required to submit a detailed project plan and make a formal presentation to ITA for review and approval. Upon approval, a periodic project status report will be required. Any changes in scope, technologies, funding, legislative mandates, and other factors will be submitted to ITA for review as they occur.

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This policy establishes a structured framework for reviewing and approving these projects to ensure significant IT investments align with statutory requirements, strategic goals, and recognized project management best practices. Agencies must submit a detailed project plan, risk assessment, and justification demonstrating alignment with agency and statewide priorities.

The goal of this policy is to promote transparency, accountability, and the successful delivery of IT projects that support mission-critical operations and public service outcomes.

III. DEFINITIONS

See ITA Guideline G105 (Glossary of Terms) for any definitions.

IV. POLICY

1. Project Profile Submission
   Upon request by the ITA, agencies must submit project profiles for specified IT projects. These profiles will be evaluated for compatibility with statewide IT and telecommunications plans, as well as ITA policies and standards.
   a. Project profiles must be submitted to: ITS Approvals Form
   b. Refer to ITA Guideline G210 (IT Project Profile) for submission requirements.
2. Project Selection for Comprehensive Review
   Based on the submitted profiles, the ITA may select certain projects for a formal, comprehensive review. Agencies will be formally notified if their project is selected.
3. Comprehensive Project Plan and Presentation
   Agencies with selected projects must submit a detailed project plan that includes:
   a. Full project scope and objectives
   b. Risk assessment
   c. Cost-benefit analysis
   d. Total cost of ownership

   Agencies will be scheduled to present the project plan to the ITA for review and approval. Presentations must demonstrate sound project management practices, demonstrate agency due diligence and address questions outlined in ITA Guideline G230 (IT Project Best Practices Checklist).

   Agencies must account for the full lifecycle costs associated with the proposed IT initiative. This includes both the initial acquisition and implementation expenses, as well as all ongoing costs incurred throughout the operational lifespan of the solution – including maintenance, support, licensing, upgrades, staffing, and decommissioning. The total cost of ownership should reflect a realistic projection of financial commitments necessary to sustain the solution and achieve its intended outcomes.
4. Ongoing Project Reporting
   Agency directors must submit periodic status reports at intervals established by the ITA. Reports must include:
   a. Progress against the original plan

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b. Updated cost estimates and completion dates
c. Explanation of any changes to milestones or objectives
d. Notification and analysis of any changes in project scope, including updated risk assessments

5. Project Completion Reporting
   Upon project completion, the agency director must submit a final report or presentation to the ITA. This report must summarize actual performance compared to the original plan and include final cost data.

V. EXEMPTION PROCESS

Refer to ITA Policy P1010 (Information Technology Policies, Standards, and Guidelines).

VI. PROCEDURE REFERENCE

Criteria for State agency IT project profiles and ITA approval are detailed in ITA Guidelines: G110 (Agency IT Plan), G210 (IT Project Profile), G215 (Risk Assessment), G225 (Cost Benefit Analysis), and G230 (IT Project Best Practices Checklist).

VII. CONTACT INFORMATION

For more information, contact the ITA Staff at (208) 605-4064.

REVISION HISTORY

05/05/2026 - Updates strengthen P2030's oversight framework, modernize structure and reporting requirements, emphasize lifecycle cost accountability, centralize definitions, and note that 'large-scale' metrics will be defined in internal ITS policy.

05/30/19 – Revised to modernize Section IV.

07/01/18 – Updated Idaho statute references.
07/01/13 – Changed "ITRMC" to "ITA".

6/15/09 – Added Definitions and Exemption Process to this policy, changed the layout and deleted Timeline.

11/15/06 – Replaced "Major Project" language with "Large-Scale Project" to remain consistent with Idaho code. Enhanced the existing IT Project Summary review process to include a more defined IT Project Profile review procedure. Provided reference to a proposed "IT Projects Best Practices Checklist."

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08/26/05 – Revised to clarify reference to statute and to emphasize that only certain, selected projects will be required to undergo greater scrutiny by the ITRMC.

Date Established: August 29, 2001

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